# James Burrow

Search Visibility Leader & AI Builder

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Lead Strategist with 20 years of digital marketing experience, specializing in technical SEO, multi-location site architecture, and AI-driven search strategy for franchise and home services brands. Promoted to team lead in late 2024 after delivering measurable organic growth and building systems the team could scale. Applies AIO/GEO/GSO daily to real client programs.

## EXPERIENCE

### Lead Strategist, Search Experience

Coalmarch · August 2023 – Present · Raleigh, NC

**Team Leadership & Development**

- Promoted to Lead Strategist within 14 months, taking on team lead responsibilities across a cross-functional Search Experience team spanning SEO and digital advertising
- Own training modules for new hire strategists and analysts; developed standardized SOPs for strategy implementation and client communication
- Building and maintaining an internal library of AI-powered workflow tools, including automated ranking dashboards, persona-city matching workflows, and SWOT analysis templates, so strategists can produce more across the team
- Collaborate with Directors of SEO and Digital Advertising to align organic and paid search strategy on shared client goals

**AI-Driven Search Strategy (AIO/GEO/GSO)**

- Actively developing and refining generative engine optimization (GEO) strategies for home services clients as AI Overviews, SGE, and Perplexity-style answer surfaces change how customers find them
- Built internal AI-powered tools with Claude that turn strategy workflows into repeatable processes, from keyword analysis and content briefs to quarterly review deliverables
- Lead search industry monitoring for the team, translating emerging AI search developments (Ask Maps, GBP AI auto-population, answer-engine consolidation) into guidance clients can act on

**Technical SEO**

- Lead site architecture strategy for multi-location franchise clients, including hub-and-spoke internal linking structure, local landing page taxonomies, and CMS platform migrations
- Execute website migrations end to end, from pre-launch redirect auditing and canonical strategy through post-launch monitoring
- Investigate and resolve complex technical SEO infrastructure issues across client sites, including redirect anomalies, GBP pipeline architecture, and CMS configuration conflicts
- Conduct WhiteSpark-based YoY ranking analysis across 100+ keyword sets, surfacing pack drift, maps recovery patterns, and market-level anomalies for strategic response

**Client Strategy & Delivery**

- Serve as primary strategist for VIP and strategic accounts in the home services vertical, managing SEO from architecture and content to performance reporting
- Developed a demographic-driven persona-to-market matching methodology using Census/ACS signals, adopted across the agency's home services client portfolio to align CMS content targeting with local audience profiles at scale
- Lead annual strategy presentations and quarterly reviews, connecting organic KPIs to revenue outcomes for account executives and client stakeholders
- Partner with Account Management, Digital Ads, and Development teams on integrated campaigns so SEO supports paid performance and technical work serves broader client growth

### SEO Specialist

Plant Delights Nursery · October 2021 – August 2023 · Raleigh, NC

- Planned and executed a product and checkout page overhaul that produced an 18% lift in add-to-cart rates and a 34% improvement in mobile checkouts, identified through conversion funnel analysis
- Drove 24% YoY organic traffic growth through technical SEO work on the Shopify platform, coordinating directly with the development team on implementation
- Managed full UA to GA4 migration with a structured data archival plan, ensuring continuity of historical reporting for stakeholder decision-making
- Coordinated multi-channel content and social media strategies to support SEO objectives; monitored search rankings and developed data-driven content strategies

### Founder

Most Optimal LLC · 2012 – 2020 · Fuquay-Varina, NC

- Founded and operated an 8-year freelance digital marketing consultancy serving clients from local SMBs to enterprise organizations
- Delivered measurable ROI across Google Ads, Bing Ads, and Facebook campaigns; managed full client relationships from strategy through reporting
- Built and maintained WordPress sites from custom theme development through server administration (Linode/Linux), operating as a full-stack digital strategist across the client portfolio
- Developed SEO strategy frameworks and client reporting systems that scaled across a diversified book of business

### Digital Marketing Manager

Internet Alliance · 2005 – 2012

- Led digital marketing strategy for a network of 25 health and medical retail sites, managing multi-million dollar online revenue streams and a five-person team across PPC, affiliate marketing, copywriting, social media, and comparison shopping engine feeds
- Developed paid and organic search strategies that drove a 54% increase in traffic from 2008–2010 and 29% revenue growth from 2007–2010
- Managed $150k+ per month in PPC ad spend across 10 business entities, reducing paid marketing expenditures by 4% while increasing traffic quality and volume; built a comparison shopping strategy that lifted monthly visits 10% and ran eBay and Amazon stores
- Established an SEO best practices framework integrated at every stage of the development cycle, reducing rework and keeping organic performance consistent across all properties

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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| **AI & Generative Search** | Claude (advanced), ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity; AIO/GEO/GSO strategy; prompt engineering; AI-powered workflow development |
| **SEO Tools & Analytics** | Google Analytics 4, Google Tag Manager, Looker Studio, Ahrefs, Moz, SEMRush, Majestic SEO, Screaming Frog, Scrapy, HotJar, Optimizely, BrightLocal, WhiteSpark |
| **Development** | HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP, Python |
| **Content Management Systems** | WordPress, Shopify, Squarespace, WooCommerce, Magento, Drupal |
| **Marketing Platforms** | Google Ads, Bing Ads, Facebook Ads, Amazon Marketplace, eBay |
| **Operating Systems** | Linux (RedHat CentOS, Ubuntu), macOS, Windows |